

Alternative English · Tomorrow's Paper

Harmony | ASSEB HS 2nd Year | Half-yearly revision companion

For Debashish · 29 September 2026 · 10:00 am–12:00 noon

This guide covers the five selections in the supplied half-yearly syllabus, plus essay, question tags, common errors and conversation comprehension. Its chapter facts were checked against your downloaded **Harmony-XII-Fullbook.pdf**. Questions, MCQs, conversations and model essays here are practice, not leaked or predicted exam questions.

First: how to write your answers

1-mark literature answer: One complete sentence, naming the exact person or fact. **2-mark answer:** Two clear points, usually two sentences. **3–5 marks:** Start with a direct answer, add two or three relevant details from the chapter, finish with the meaning/theme if asked. For a poem, explain the image as well as what it suggests. Do not retell the whole chapter for a short question.

Essay format (no fixed decorative heading required): Write the topic as a title. Paragraph 1: introduce your idea. Paragraphs 2–3: two distinct points, with an example. Final paragraph: a balanced conclusion. Keep to the word limit on *your actual paper*; the model essays below are practice, not an official word count. Avoid unsupported facts, long quotations and memorised essays that do not answer the prompt. Harmony itself prescribes **introduction** → **body** → **conclusion** and says essay questions can draw on literature/culture, science/technology, values, agriculture/economy, sports or travel (book PDF pp. 105–107).

Conversation comprehension format: You are normally given a conversation to *read*, not asked to compose one. Read the speakers and setting first; locate each answer in their actual words. Number your answers, write complete sentences and copy vocabulary answers exactly from the passage. Harmony advises against adding things not present in the dialogue (PDF pp. 121–123).

Grammar answer format: For question tags, rewrite the statement and append the tag after a comma: “She is ready, isn't she?” For common errors, rewrite the *whole correct sentence*, not just the changed word. Positive statement → negative tag; negative statement or negative idea (few, seldom, nobody) → positive tag. “Let's” → “shall we?” Requests → “will you?” (Harmony PDF pp. 111–116).

The paper pattern: what is known, what is not

The **2025 and 2026 final board papers** are 100 marks in three hours: prose 40, poetry 30, grammar 10 (five question tags + five corrected sentences), and writing/comprehension 20 (one essay from four topics, 10; one conversation passage, 10). The **district half-yearly paper tomorrow is two hours**. Do **not** assume the full-board weights, number of options or essay length carry over to it; follow the printed question paper. The 2025 essay choices included *Women Empowerment*, *Knowledge is Power*, *Global Warming and the Future of Mankind*, and *My Dream Holiday Destination*; 2026 choices included *Sports as a Career in India*, *Youth Empowerment*, *India's North-East as a Tourism Destination*, and *The Importance of Ecological Conservation*. These show broad themes, not a reliable prediction for tomorrow.

Revision route tonight: read five summaries → test yourself with the short answers and MCQs → write one essay from memory → do both grammar sets → attempt one unseen conversation. Rest before the morning exam.

Part I · Literature

1. A Cup of Tea — Katherine Mansfield

Summary. Wealthy Rosemary Fell meets a hungry young woman, Miss Smith, outside an antique shop. Instead of giving her tea money, Rosemary takes her home, delighted by the idea of playing the generous heroine. She feeds her guest, but her husband Philip calls Miss Smith “astonishingly pretty.” Rosemary’s jealousy displaces her charity: she gives the girl money and sends her away. Her final question to Philip —“am I pretty?”—reveals her insecurity and the limits of her kindness.

Notable details. Rosemary admires an enamel box priced at **twenty-eight guineas** but initially leaves it in the shop. Miss Smith asks only for the price of a cup of tea. Rosemary takes **three five-pound notes** after putting two of five notes back; the story does not directly show the handover, though Rosemary says she gave Miss Smith money. Its contrasts are luxury versus hunger, and professed charity versus vanity.

Short Q&A 1. **Who is Rosemary Fell?** A rich, fashionable young woman married to Philip. 2. **What does Miss Smith ask for?** The price of a cup of tea. 3. **Why does Rosemary send her away?** Philip’s praise of Miss Smith’s beauty makes Rosemary jealous. 4. **What does Rosemary ask Philip at the end?** “Am I pretty?”

MCQs 1. Who wrote the story? A) Emily Dickinson B) Katherine Mansfield C) W. Somerset Maugham D) P. B. Shelley. **Answer: B.** 2. What does Rosemary examine in the antique shop? A) A ring B) A vase C) An enamel box D) A portrait. **Answer: C.** 3. What is the young woman’s name? A) Miss Smith B) Miss Brown C) Miss Rose D) Miss Jones. **Answer: A.** 4. Which remark unsettles Rosemary? A) The girl is wealthy B) The girl is astonishingly pretty C) The box is sold D) Philip is leaving. **Answer: B.**

2. The Voyage — Bhupen Hazarika

Summary. Hazarika recalls his journey abroad towards the United States in **1949**, travelling through India and Sri Lanka, then taking a sea voyage from Colombo towards Marseille. A forgotten bag containing travel papers briefly delays his departure at Guwahati's Kanhikuchi Airport. In Sri Lanka he observes cultural links between its dance and Assam's traditions. On the voyage he notices poverty at Djibouti and memorable sights at sea, including a star near the crescent moon and luminous fish. His outward journey also enlarges his sense of cultural kinship and Indian identity.

Notable details. He planned an indirect route to see more places; the ship journey from Colombo to Marseille was to take **thirteen days**. The Sri Lankan **Yakuma Natum** recalls Assam's **deodhani** dance. He buys a **Rolleiflex camera at Aden**; at Djibouti he observes poverty; he does **not** see the pyramids on this journey. Do not confuse this autobiographical travel account with a generic allegory of a river or attribute it to Katherine Mansfield.

Short Q&A 1. **Why was the plane stopped at Kanhikuchi?** Hazarika discovered that his bag with his passport and other papers was missing; it was fetched before the flight continued. 2. **Why did he choose an indirect route?** He wished to see other countries and cultures on his way abroad. 3. **What Assamese dance did the Yakuma Natum recall?** Deodhani dance. 4. **What two unusual sights did he see at sea?** A star beside or above the crescent moon, and luminous phosphorescent fish.

MCQs 1. Who narrates *The Voyage*? A) Albert Edward Foreman B) Bhupen Hazarika C) Philip Fell D) Percy Shelley. **Answer: B.** 2. In what year did the journey begin? A) 1919 B) 1939 C) 1949 D) 1969. **Answer: C.** 3. Where did he board the ship for Marseille? A) Guwahati B) Colombo C) Paris D) Djibouti. **Answer: B.** 4. What did he buy at Aden? A) A Rolleiflex camera B) A pair of shoes C) A radio D) A painting. **Answer: A.**

3. The Verger — W. Somerset Maugham

Summary. Albert Edward Foreman has served for sixteen years as verger of St Peter's, Neville Square. The new vicar learns that he cannot read or write and demands that he learn within three months or leave. Foreman resigns. While walking home, he finds a street without a tobacco shop and opens one himself. His tobacconist-and-newsagent business expands to ten shops and substantial savings. When a bank manager wonders what he could have become if literate, Foreman replies that he would have remained the verger. The irony celebrates practical judgement while exposing the vicar's narrow measure of ability.

Notable details. The new vicar praises Foreman's work but regards illiteracy as an unacceptable risk. Foreman notices the opportunity when he wants a cigarette and cannot find a shop. He learns to **sign his name after entering business**; he does **not** become fully literate. After ten years his deposit is **a little over £30,000**. The ending is ironic, not an argument that schooling is worthless.

Short Q&A 1. **Where and how long had Foreman been verger?** At St Peter's, Neville Square, for sixteen years. 2. **What condition did the new vicar impose?** Learn to read and write within three months or leave the post. 3. **How did Foreman find his business idea?** He found no shop selling cigarettes on a long street and spotted an unmet demand. 4. **What is his answer to the bank manager's final question?** If he could read and write, he would still be verger of St Peter's.

MCQs 1. What is Foreman's first name? A) Philip B) Albert Edward C) Andre D) William. **Answer: B.** 2. What made the new vicar demand a change? A) Theft B) Foreman's illiteracy C) Late attendance D) Smoking in church. **Answer: B.** 3. What business does Foreman establish? A) Florist B) Bookbinder C) Tobacconist and newsagent D) Bank. **Answer: C.** 4. How many shops does he acquire within ten years? A) Two B) Five C) Ten D) Twenty. **Answer: C.**

4. Ozymandias of Egypt — Percy Bysshe Shelley

Summary. A traveller describes the broken statue of Ozymandias in a vast desert: two trunkless legs stand near a shattered face. The sculptor has preserved the ruler's arrogant expression, and the pedestal boasts of the king's mighty works. Yet no empire remains in sight—only the ruined monument and endless sand. The boast becomes ironic: political power decays, while art and the poem preserve its memory.

Notable details. The poem is a **sonnet** framed as the traveller's report; the speaker did not claim to see the ruins firsthand. The sculptor captured the "sneer of cold command." "Look on my works, ye Mighty, and despair!" is written on the pedestal, but "Nothing beside remains." The textbook title adds "**of Egypt**" to the familiar poem title *Ozymandias*.

Short Q&A 1. **Who describes the statue to the speaker?** A traveller from an antique land. 2. **What remains of the statue?** Two huge trunkless legs, a half-buried broken face, and its pedestal. 3. **What does the sculptor capture?** The king's proud, harsh expression and passions. 4. **Why is the inscription ironic?** It praises magnificent works where only a wreck and empty desert remain.

MCQs 1. Who wrote the poem? A) Shelley B) Dickinson C) Mansfield D) Maugham. **Answer: A.** 2. What is the statue's face called? A) Tippet B) Visage C) Cornice D) Gown. **Answer: B.** 3. What surrounds the wreck? A) Palaces B) Forest C) Lone, level sands D) Crowds. **Answer: C.** 4. What does "king of kings" express in context? A) Humility B) Ozymandias's pride C) The sculptor's name D) The traveller's fear. **Answer: B.**

5. Because I Could Not Stop for Death — Emily Dickinson

Summary. The speaker imagines Death as a courteous carriage companion who stops for her; Immortality also rides with them. They pass a school, fields of grain, and the setting sun. The mood darkens as the sun passes them and the air turns cold. They pause at a house resembling a swelling in the ground—a grave. Looking back after centuries, the speaker recalls realizing that the horses were travelling towards Eternity. The poem presents death as a journey, but its chill and final uncertainty complicate the initial courtesy.

Notable details. Death is **personified** as "kindly" and marked by "Civility"; the carriage contains the speaker, Death and Immortality. The three passing scenes can suggest stages of life, though that is an interpretation rather than an explicit label in the text. In the original poem the speaker corrects herself: "Or rather—He passed Us—" after saying they passed the setting sun. The barely visible roof and buried cornice identify the "House" as a grave; "Gossamer" and "Tulle" show how lightly she is dressed against the cold.

Short Q&A 1. **Who stops for the speaker?** Death, imagined as a courteous companion. 2. **Who else rides in the carriage?** Immortality. 3. **Which scenes do they pass?** A school with children, fields of gazing grain, and the setting sun. 4. **What is the house in the ground?** The grave.

MCQs 1. Who wrote the poem? A) Mansfield B) Dickinson C) Shelley D) Hazarika. **Answer: B.** 2. How does Death travel? A) By ship B) On foot C) In a carriage D) By train. **Answer: C.** 3. What does the speaker wear against the chill? A) A wool coat B) Gossamer and tulle C) Armour D) A shawl of fur. **Answer: B.** 4. Towards what are the horses' heads directed? A) School B) The sea C) Eternity D) The palace. **Answer: C.**

Deeper answers to practise

A Cup of Tea

Why does Rosemary take Miss Smith home? Rosemary is moved by the girl's hunger, but she also likes the thought of doing something dramatic and generous, like a scene from a novel. Her invitation has kindness in it, yet she imagines telling her friends about it. The story makes us question whether she sees Miss Smith as a person or as a part in her own adventure.

How is the ending ironic? Rosemary has spoken of helping a poor woman and of sisterhood. But when Philip praises Miss Smith's beauty, Rosemary's concern turns to jealousy. She sends the girl away with money and asks Philip whether she herself is pretty. The woman who seemed secure in her wealth ends up seeking reassurance about her looks.

The Voyage

How does travel change Hazarika's sense of home? At first he misses Assam deeply, carrying a drying flower given to him at the airport. Farther from home, he feels attached to all of India. In Sri Lanka, local dance and Buddhist places remind him of Indian and Assamese traditions. He sees that culture can connect people beyond political borders.

What makes the voyage more than a travel diary? Besides places and incidents, Hazarika records how they affect him. The forgotten bag shows a nervous beginning; Sri Lankan dance shows cultural kinship; poverty in Djibouti troubles him; the moon and luminous fish fill him with wonder. The journey becomes an account of curiosity, human sympathy and a widening sense of belonging.

The Verger

Why did Foreman lose his job despite serving well? The new vicar discovers that Foreman cannot read or write. Although Foreman has served St Peter's faithfully for sixteen years, the vicar considers his illiteracy an unacceptable risk. He gives Foreman three months to learn. Foreman refuses and resigns, choosing dignity rather than accepting the condition.

Explain the last line. The bank manager wonders what Foreman might have become had he been literate. Foreman replies that he would still be verger at St Peter's. If he had kept that job, he would never have noticed the empty market for a tobacco shop. The ending turns a setback into an unexpected opportunity without saying that education itself is useless.

Ozymandias of Egypt

What is the central idea of the poem? Ozymandias calls himself “King of Kings” and orders the powerful to admire his works. Yet his statue lies broken, and empty sand surrounds it. Time has outlasted his empire. The sculptor's skill preserves the king's proud expression, but cannot preserve his rule. The poem questions pride in political power.

Explain the irony of the inscription. The pedestal commands the mighty to look upon Ozymandias's works and despair. The traveller sees no mighty works nearby: only broken stone and “lone and level sands.” The words meant to proclaim lasting greatness now reveal how completely that greatness has vanished.

Because I Could Not Stop for Death

What do the scenes on the journey suggest? The school with children, fields of grain and setting sun may suggest childhood, maturity and the close of life. The poem does not label the stages outright; the speaker observes them as the carriage moves slowly on. When the sun passes them and the air grows cold, Death's gentle manner feels less comforting.

Why is the house important? The “House” is a grave, suggested by its swelling ground, scarcely visible roof and cornice in the earth. Death's polite carriage ride pauses there. From that point the speaker speaks as someone who has been dead for centuries, looking back on a journey that leads toward Eternity.

Part II · Writing and practice

Four original model essays (approximately 160 words each)

1. Women Empowerment (a 2025 board choice)

Women empowerment means giving women the freedom and opportunity to shape their own lives. It begins at home, where a daughter deserves the same encouragement to learn and dream as a son.

Education opens doors, but opportunity must follow it. A young woman should be able to choose a profession, earn fairly and make decisions about her future. Safe public spaces, respectful workplaces and access to healthcare are equally important. Families can help by sharing household work instead of treating it as a woman's duty alone.

Empowerment is not a contest between women and men. When a woman can use her abilities, her family and community benefit too. A teacher guides children, an entrepreneur creates jobs, and a leader can speak for those whose voices are seldom heard.

Laws matter, but attitudes matter just as much. We should challenge unfair jokes, listen to girls and support their ambitions. A society grows stronger when everyone has room to grow.

2. Global Warming and the Future of Mankind (a 2025 board choice)

Global warming is the gradual rise in Earth's temperature. Human activities, especially burning coal, oil and gas, add heat-trapping gases to the atmosphere. The result is not only hotter days; changing weather can affect farms, homes and health.

In Assam, a flood can interrupt classes and damage a family's livelihood. Elsewhere, drought may leave farmers without enough water. Wildlife also suffers when forests and habitats change. Poor families often have the fewest resources to recover from such losses.

There is no single magic solution. Governments must support cleaner energy, protect forests and prepare communities for extreme weather. We can save electricity, avoid waste and choose public transport when practical. Planting trees helps, but protecting mature trees matters as well.

The future of mankind depends on choices made today. We do not need to live without comfort; we need to use resources wisely. If people work together, a safer and fairer future is still possible.

3. Youth Empowerment (a 2026 board choice)

Young people are often called the future of a country, but they are also part of its present. Youth empowerment means giving them knowledge, skills and a genuine chance to take part in decisions.

Education should teach more than answers for an examination. Students need to ask questions, work with others and learn practical skills. A village youth group, for example, can organise a reading corner or help keep a riverbank clean. Such work builds confidence and a sense of responsibility.

Adults have a role too. They should listen without dismissing every new idea, provide safe spaces for discussion and guide young people through mistakes. Access to training and fair employment matters more than empty praise. Young women and men must receive equal opportunities.

Young people also need to use freedom responsibly. They should check information before sharing it and respect different opinions. With support and self-discipline, their energy can become useful action that improves both their lives and their communities.

4. India's North-East as a Tourism Destination (a 2026 board choice)

India's North-East invites visitors with its rivers, hills, forests and living traditions. In Assam, the Brahmaputra shapes daily life, while tea gardens and local markets offer different ways to understand the region. A journey here can be more than a collection of photographs.

Travellers can learn from local food, crafts, music and festivals. They can stay in small homestays and speak with hosts about their surroundings. Such visits can support guides, drivers, artisans and family businesses. Yet tourism also brings pressure: litter, crowded roads and damage to fragile places.

Good tourism should therefore respect people and nature. Visitors can follow local rules, avoid plastic waste and pay fairly for services. Communities should have a voice in how tourism develops, rather than losing control of their homes to outsiders.

The North-East is not a single culture or a single landscape. Its beauty lies in its variety. A thoughtful visitor returns with memories and leaves the place worthy of another visit.

Four original conversation-comprehension drills

Use the board-style format: read each conversation, then answer the numbered questions in full sentences. Each set totals **10 marks**; model answers follow. These passages and questions are original, not copied board questions.

Passage A: A school reading corner

Rina: Why are these books in the corridor, Kabir?

Kabir: Our class is setting up a reading corner. The library closes before some bus students can visit it.

Rina: Where will the books come from?

Kabir: Teachers have donated twenty books, and students may lend one each. We will write the owner's name inside every borrowed book.

Rina: Who will look after them?

Kabir: Two volunteers will take turns at lunch. They will record loans in a notebook and return the books on Fridays.

Rina: Can anyone use the corner?

Kabir: Yes, but the books must remain in good condition. Our aim is access, not a competition over who reads most.

1. Why is the class setting up a reading corner? (2)
2. Give two sources of books. (2)
3. How will the volunteers manage loans? (2)
4. What is Kabir's aim, and what must readers do? (2)
5. Find words in the passage meaning (i) people who offer help without being required to; (ii) reach or opportunity to use something. (1 + 1)

Key: 1. Some bus students cannot visit the library before it closes, so the class is creating another place to read. 2. Teachers donate books, and students lend books. 3. Two volunteers take turns at lunch, record loans in a notebook and return books on Fridays. 4. He wants access rather than a reading contest; readers must keep the books in good condition. 5. (i) volunteers; (ii) access.

Passage B: Choosing a course

Mother: You seem uncertain about your course application, Neel.

Neel: I enjoy biology, but my friends think I should study engineering.

Mother: Have you asked a teacher about your options?

Neel: Yes. Sen Ma'am suggested that I compare the subjects and talk to people who work in both fields.

Mother: That sounds sensible. Is the deadline close?

Neel: It is next Monday. I will visit the college website tonight and write down my questions.

Mother: What matters most to you?

Neel: I want a course that suits my interests and abilities, not merely one that sounds fashionable.

Mother: Then make a careful choice. We can discuss the costs together tomorrow.

1. Which subject does Neel enjoy? (1)
2. Why does he feel pulled towards engineering? (1)

3. What two steps did Sen Ma'am suggest? (2)
4. What will Neel do tonight and when is the deadline? (2)
5. Explain Neel's view of a suitable course. (3)
6. Find a word meaning "reasonable and practical." (1)

Key: 1. Biology. 2. His friends think he should study engineering. 3. Compare the subjects and speak to people working in both fields. 4. He will visit the college website and note his questions tonight; the deadline is next Monday. 5. It should match his interests and abilities; he does not want to choose merely because a course is fashionable. 6. sensible.

Passage C: A cleaner festival

Tara: Will the festival committee still give out plastic cups?

Imran: No. We have arranged steel cups that can be washed and reused.

Tara: Who will wash them during the event?

Imran: Volunteers will collect them at two return desks. A local group will wash them in clean water behind the hall.

Tara: What about the food stalls?

Imran: Stall owners have agreed to keep separate bins for food scraps and other waste. We will put clear signs above the bins.

Tara: Will all this be expensive?

Imran: We must pay a deposit for the cups, but we expect to get it back after returning them. Reducing waste is worth the effort.

1. What will replace plastic cups, and why? (2)
2. Where can visitors return used cups? (1)
3. Who washes the cups and where? (2)
4. What will stall owners do with waste? (2)
5. Why does Imran expect to recover the deposit? (2)
6. Find a word meaning "used again." (1)

Key: 1. Washable, reusable steel cups will replace disposable plastic cups. 2. At two return desks. 3. A local group will wash them in clean water behind the hall. 4. They will use separate bins for food scraps and other waste. 5. The committee expects the deposit back when it returns the cups. 6. reused.

Passage D: Sport and study

Coach: Why did you miss practice yesterday, Maya?

Maya: I had a science test this morning and needed extra revision. I should have informed you earlier.

Coach: Thank you for saying so. How can you manage both next week?

Maya: I can revise for an hour before dinner and attend practice on Tuesday and Thursday.

Coach: The match is on Saturday. Can you come for a short session on Friday too?

Maya: Yes, if it ends by five. My bus leaves at five fifteen.

Coach: Agreed. We will practise passing, not play a full match. Remember to rest on Friday night.

Maya: I will. I want to play well without neglecting my studies.

1. Why did Maya miss practice, and what does she admit she should have done? (2)
2. On which two days can she attend regular practice? (2)
3. Why must Friday's session end by five? (1)
4. What will the team practise on Friday instead of playing a full match? (1)
5. How does Maya plan to balance sport and study? Give three details. (3)
6. Find a word meaning "not giving enough attention to." (1)

Key: 1. She revised for a science test and admits she should have informed the coach earlier. 2. Tuesday and Thursday. 3. Her bus leaves at five fifteen. 4. Passing. 5. She will revise before dinner, attend two regular practices and join a short Friday session; she also intends to rest. 6. neglecting.

Grammar: board-style mini-practice

The 2025 and 2026 Q12/Q13 both used **question tags** and **error correction**, rather than the broader grammar pattern of a different English subject. For a positive statement use a negative tag and vice versa; *rarely*, *seldom*, *few*, *no* usually make the clause negative. Match the auxiliary and subject, including *aren't I?*, *shall we?* after *let's*, and *will you?* for requests.

A. Add tags (try all eight; a board paper asks any five).

1. The bus has left, _____?
2. She doesn't play tennis, _____?
3. Let's start now, _____?
4. I am early, _____?
5. Nobody called us, _____?
6. He seldom misses class, _____?
7. Please close the door, _____?
8. Everyone enjoyed the play, _____?

Key: 1. hasn't it? 2. does she? 3. shall we? 4. aren't I? 5. did they? 6. does he? 7. will you? 8. didn't they? (*Everyone* takes singular verb in the statement but commonly *they* in the tag.)

B. Correct and rewrite each sentence (board style: any five of eight).

1. One of my friend lives in Jorhat.
2. She prefers tea than coffee.
3. He is an university student.
4. The teacher, along with her pupils, are ready.
5. I have lived here since three years.
6. Neither of the answers are correct.
7. This is a useful informations.
8. He is senior than me.

Key: 1. One of my friends lives in Jorhat. 2. She prefers tea to coffee. 3. He is a university student. 4. The teacher, along with her pupils, is ready. 5. I have lived here for three years. 6. Neither of the answers is correct. 7. This is useful information. 8. He is senior to me.

Final check: use the actual school paper's instructions for choices and marks; don't assume a particular essay, dialogue topic, or 160-word requirement will appear.

Last-minute recall card

- **Rosemary:** Miss Smith asks for tea; Philip calls her pretty; charity collapses into jealousy.
- **Hazarika:** 1949; Kanhikuchi airport; Colombo; Yakuma Natum/deodhani; Aden camera; sea sights.
- **Foreman:** 16 years as verger; cannot read/write; three months; tobacco shops; £30,000; final irony.
- **Ozymandias:** traveller's story; shattered face; sculptor; proud inscription; empty sands.
- **Dickinson:** Death + Immortality + speaker; school/grain/sun; chill; grave; Eternity.

Sources and scope

1. **Primary:** *Harmony: An Anthology of Prose & Poetry*, your local *Harmony-XII-Fullbook.pdf*. Prose appears at PDF pp. 11–22, 23–35 and 36–46; assigned poems at PDF pp. 79–84; essay at 105–107; grammar at 111–116; comprehension at 121–127. These are **PDF page numbers**, not the printed book page numbers. OCR of this scanned file was checked against the pages for names, numbers and key plot points.
2. **Past-paper pattern and essay choices:** [2025 board paper](#) and [2026 board paper](#). They are final board papers, not a verified half-yearly blueprint.
3. **Half-yearly exam time and syllabus:** your district routine and college-issued half-yearly syllabus previously shared in chat. Only the specified five literary selections are treated as assigned here; the remaining Harmony chapters are intentionally omitted.

Prepared for revision, not as an official model answer key. In a dispute, your teacher's prescribed scope and the printed question paper take priority.